

The Stars That Sank Us To Sleep — Part 1: Lullaby

A story-first 2D stealth and physics escape game, playable in the browser.

Genre	Narrative stealth + physics puzzle, 2D side view	Engine	Godot 4 (GDScript), HTML5 export on itch.io, desktop browsers
Length	One 15–20 minute playthrough: Acts 1–3 and finale	Repo	github.com/panemchaitanya/Evangelion-GameJam (public, MIT)
Controls	Keyboard: move, interact, Tab to switch kid	Code	All code written inside the 100-hour window

TEAM

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1. CONCEPT

On an alien world, children grow up in a warm orphanage on a walled farm, raised by "Mom" and her wardens. At twelve, each child is called to the gate and told they have been adopted. The gate does not lead to a family. It leads to a slaughterhouse: the children are livestock, and their chores and tests are how they are graded. You play three of the kids who find out, and you have to get all three over the wall. The game ends on a quiet scene instead of a boss fight: the woman who ran the house lets you go.

The premise is a deliberate homage to the manga/anime *The Promised Neverland*. What is ours: the alien farm setting, the escape as a physics problem, three kids with different bodies, and light as the core stealth system.

2. CHARACTERS

Character	Role in play	Role in story
The Small One	Lightest kid. Fits through vents and gaps, crosses thin ledges and light ropes. Cannot move crates.	Youngest. Hums an old lullaby without knowing where it comes from.
The Strong One	Pushes and stacks crates, hauls ropes, holds a rope for the others. Loud when moving heavy things.	The muscle. Riskier in stealth.
The Oldest	Sees the plan overlay: patrol paths and timings. Marks the route for the others.	Next in line for the gate. Has the most to lose.
Mom + one night warden	Patrol with vision cones and lanterns. Patrol, investigate, alert states.	Mom runs the house with warmth and strict control. She is as trapped as the kids.

3. STORY FLOW (FULL SPOILERS)

Act	What happens	What the player does
1 · The lie	Daily life in the house. A friend is "adopted" and everyone celebrates. The Small One hums a tune at bedtime; nobody reacts.	Learns movement, switching kids, and the wardens' routes. It feels safe.
2 · Twist one	The kids sneak to the gate at night to return a forgotten toy and see the "delivery". The adopted friend is cargo. They are the crop.	Tone flips. Chore tools (ropes, crates, carts) become escape tools. Night runs begin.
3 · Final twist	Mom catches the Small One. Cornered, the Small One hums the lullaby. Mom freezes: it is her song. She is the Small One's birth mother, and was once a farm child herself.	No new mechanic. Mom's earlier cruelty now reads differently.
Finale	The wall and the swing-line. The kids cross one by one. Mom reaches the rope, holds it, and does not cut it. The doorway light behind her is the first light on their side.	Uses everything learned about light, weight and ropes. Ends on the hum.

4. CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

Day (short, guided): do chores to stay unsuspecting, pick up materials (rope, planks, a pulley), and watch the wardens to learn their routes. **Night**: build a contraption from what you collected, then run the route in the dark while switching between the three kids. Getting caught restarts the current night, not the whole game. Each attempt is a few minutes long, so retrying is cheap.

Stealth

- **Light exposure.** Searchlights and lanterns use Godot's 2D lights. Standing in light fills an exposure meter (shown as a screen-edge tint). Full exposure ends the attempt.
- **Darkness is cover.** Knocking over a lantern or blocking a light is a real tool. The same light data drives both the look and the detection.
- **Patrols.** Fixed waypoint routes with a vision cone and a hearing radius. Noise from physics collisions draws wardens over.

Physics

- **Ropes and pulleys.** Rope made of jointed segments. A pulley lets a light kid lift a heavy load.
- **Crate stacks.** Stacking is real. Bad stacks tip over and make noise.
- **Swing-line.** A rope across the wall gap. Mass decides who can cross and how: the heavy kid anchors, the light kid swings first.
- **Character switching.** An idle kid stays physical, so a kid left holding a rope is part of the contraption.

5. HOW THE GAME USES THE THREE THEMES

Comic	Manga homage: the premise and the Mom character are a direct reference to <i>The Promised Neverland</i> . Art: anime-style characters with large, readable faces against dark, silhouette-heavy rooms. Comic-panel cutscenes: every story beat, including both twists, is told as a page of manga panels that fill in one at a time, with speech bubbles. Comedy: physics failures are funny before they are scary: a crate stack slowly leaning over, the Strong One flung off a rope. This keeps the mood from becoming only grim.
Twist	Story twist 1: adoption is the harvest. The happy house is a farm. Story twist 2: Mom is the Small One's mother, revealed only through the lullaby the player has been hearing since Act 1. Gameplay twist: after twist one, every chore object you used in Act 1 turns out to be an escape tool. The same rope that hung laundry carries you over the wall.
Light	Mechanic: light is danger and darkness is safety; the whole stealth system is built on 2D lights and shadows. Story and colour: warm amber light inside the house is the lie, cold blue light outside is the truth. The final doorway light behind Mom is the only warm light that is on your side: hope. Weight: the lightest kid is the key to the escape. Light bodies cross ropes and swing farther; heavy bodies anchor. The game is "light" in both meanings.

6. SCOPE WE COMMIT TO, AND WHAT WE CUT FIRST

Committed (this is what the final build will have)

- One house, one yard, one wall; Acts 1-3 and the finale playable end to end.
- Three switchable kids with different abilities.
- Light exposure stealth with searchlights, lanterns and two patrolling wardens (Mom + one).
- Rope, crate stack and swing-line physics, stable in the web build.
- Manga-panel cutscenes for every story beat, original lullaby melody.

Stretch (only if time allows, cut in this order)

- A third warden and extra patrol behaviours.
- Rewind-on-failure (fallback: restart the night).
- More chain-reaction distractions beyond the feed cart and lantern.
- Longer day phase with suspicion meters and note-passing.

Plan (jam hours): 12-25 web export, movement, switching, one lit room with exposure · 25-45 rope, crate and swing-line working in the browser · 45-70 Acts 1-2 playable with art and patrols · 70-88 Act 3, finale, cutscenes, lullaby · 88-100 polish, audio, itch.io page; no new features. **Main risk:** jointed ropes jittering in web builds, so ropes are prototyped first and segment counts kept low.

Art: 2D sprites made with AI-assisted concepts and hand cleanup against one style sheet. Audio: lullaby composed by the team; ambience and impact sounds from CC0 libraries, credited in the repo.